Islamabad plot listings: what the scrape actually contains

Zameen.com asking prices for plots in Islamabad. Source: kaggle.com/datasets/saroshkhann/islamabad-plots-prices-dataset

The dataset

The file is a raw scrape of plot listings from Zameen.com, 18,700 rows and six columns: listing title, price as text, location, area, the listing URL and the results page the row was scraped from. There are no dates and no missing values. The natural question to ask of it is what a marla of land costs in different parts of Islamabad.

It cannot really answer that, and the reason is the first finding. The file contains only 25 distinct listings. Every one of them appears exactly 748 times, once for each value of the page number from 1 to 748, and the set of 25 is identical on every page. It looks as though the scraper kept saving the first results page while the page counter ran on, although the file itself does not say what went wrong. Either way, 18,675 of the 18,700 rows (99.87%) are repeats, and what is left is a snapshot of 25 adverts.

One more point of framing: these are asking prices taken from adverts, not prices at which anything changed hands.

Cleaning

Rows were reduced to one per listing URL, which takes the table from 18,700 rows to 25, and the page number column was dropped since it no longer means anything. Prices came as text in lakh or crore (no other units appear) and were converted to rupees. Areas came in marla or kanal and were converted to marla at 20 marla to the kanal. Six titles quote plot dimensions in feet, and they fit a marla of 225 square feet rather than 272.25: five match the listed area exactly and one (a 25x50 plot in I-12 listed as 5 marla) had simply been rounded down from 5.6.

The 22 raw location strings were standardised into 17 localities, for example I-12/1 and I-12 into I-12, and the DHA phases into DHA Defence with the phase kept separately. Each locality was then put in one of three broad groups: lettered sectors (names like E-12 or F-11), DHA Defence, and other housing societies. Listings that may not be comparable to an ordinary plot were flagged from their titles rather than removed: a pair of plots in Park Enclave whose area is given as one kanal, a plot file in C-15, a commercial plot in Sky Gardens, one advert mentioning instalments, and one in D-18 titled as a residence. Two listings fall outside the usual 1.5 x IQR fence on price per marla (above 55.6 lakh). They are plausible prices for central sectors, so they were kept and medians are used throughout.

What the 25 listings show

Asking price per marla runs from 3.2 lakh to 76.25 lakh, a spread of about 24 to 1. The median is 16.51 lakh and the mean 22.89 lakh; the gap between the two comes from the plots in D-12 and F-11, at 76.25 and 75.27 lakh per marla, which stand well clear of everything else. Next come Margalla Enclave at 49.00 and E-12 at 47.73. At the other end, a 10 marla plot in AWT is listed at 32 lakh, or 3.2 lakh per marla.

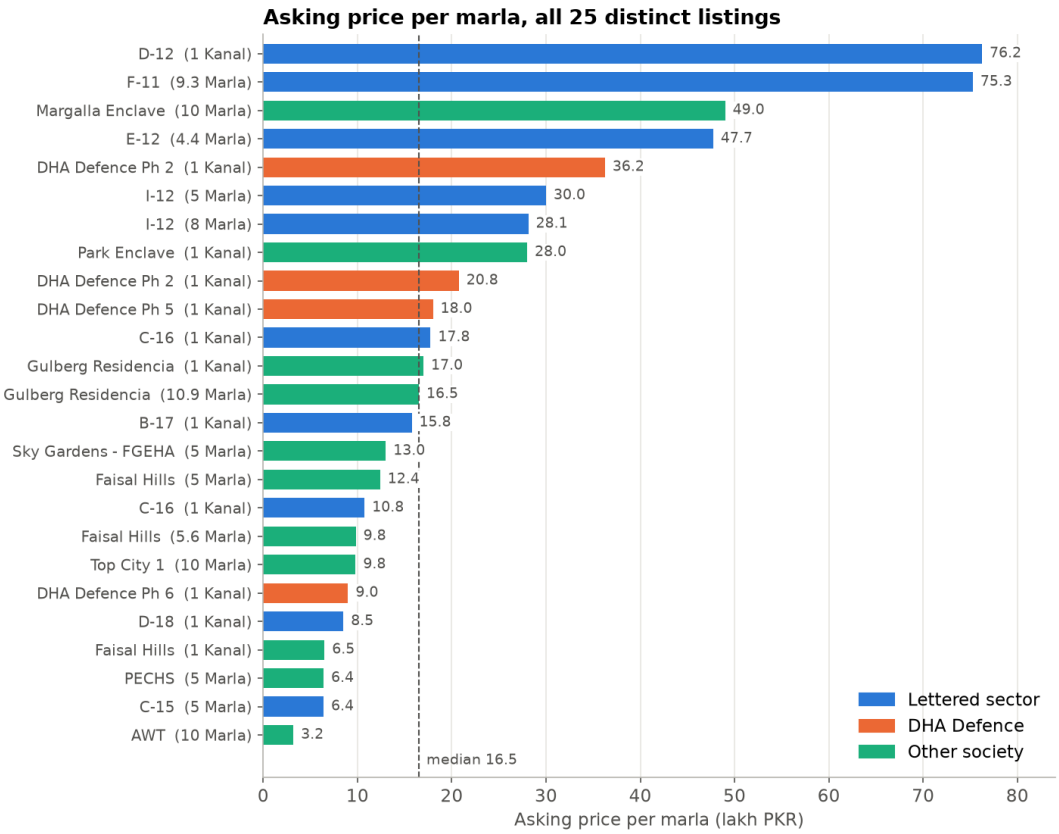


Figure 1. Each bar is one listing, not a location average.

Grouping by type of location gives a rough ordering. The lettered sectors have the highest median at 22.94 lakh per marla across 10 listings, DHA Defence follows at 19.38 across 4, and the other societies are lowest at 12.40 across 11. The sector group is extremely wide, though, from 6.4 to 76.25 lakh, because it holds both the central sectors and outlying ones such as C-15 and D-18. The label on its own tells you little.

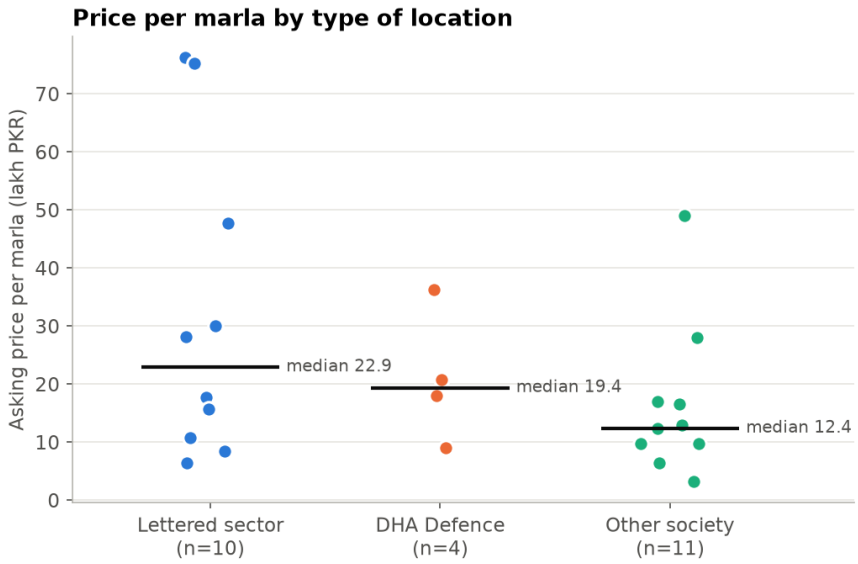


Figure 2. Dots are listings, the bar is the group median.

A proper ranking of locations needs a minimum number of listings per location, and here that is where the analysis runs out. Of the 17 localities, 12 have a single listing and none has more than 4. Only five have two or more, shown below. Even those disagree with themselves: the 4 DHA Defence plots are

all one kanal, yet they range from 1.8 crore in Phase 6 to 7.25 crore for a boulevard corner plot in Phase 2.

Locality	Listings	Median	Lowest	Highest
I-12	2	29.06	28.12	30.00
DHA Defence	4	19.38	9.00	36.25
Gulberg Residencia	2	16.76	16.51	17.00
C-16	2	14.25	10.75	17.75
Faisal Hills	3	9.82	6.50	12.40

Table 1. Asking price per marla in lakh PKR, localities with at least two listings. Indicative only.

Plot size matters less than one might expect. 12 of the 25 listings are exactly one kanal and 5 are exactly five marla. Larger plots cost more in total (rank correlation 0.58), but price per marla has no relationship with size in this sample (0.06). One kanal plots alone go from 1.3 crore in Faisal Hills to 15.25 crore in D-12, a factor of 11.7. Where the plot is dominates how big it is.

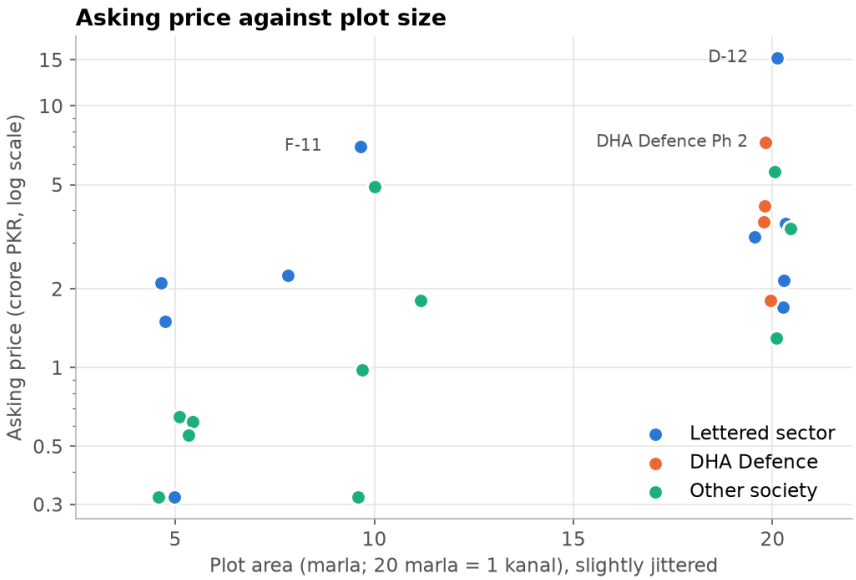


Figure 3. Total asking price against area. One kanal plots span more than a tenfold range.

Highest, lowest, most

- Highest asking price: 15.25 crore for a one kanal corner plot in D-12, which is also the highest per marla at 76.25 lakh.
- Second highest per marla: F-11, 7 crore for 9.3 marla, 75.27 lakh.
- Lowest asking price: 32 lakh, shared by 3 listings (C-15, PECHS, AWT).
- Lowest per marla: AWT, 3.2 lakh.
- Cheapest one kanal plot: Faisal Hills at 1.3 crore (6.5 lakh per marla).
- Smallest plot: 4.4 marla in E-12, asking 2.1 crore.
- Most common size: one kanal, 12 of 25 listings.
- Most listings in one locality: DHA Defence with 4, then Faisal Hills with 3.
- Median asking price 2.1 crore; 18 of 25 listings ask one crore or more.
- Repeated rows in the raw file: 18,675 of 18,700.

Conclusion and limits

The honest summary is that this file is a 25-listing sample presented as 18,700 rows. Within those 25, central lettered sectors ask several times more per marla than outlying sectors and private societies, and location swamps plot size. That is a description of these adverts and should not be quoted as Islamabad market prices.

The limits are substantial. Twenty-five adverts cannot support a location ranking. The prices are what sellers ask, not what buyers paid. There is no date, so the period is unknown and nothing can be said about trends. The 25 are whatever appeared on one results page, so they are not a random sample of the market. A handful are not like-for-like, and for the Park Enclave pair it is unclear whether the price covers one plot or two, which would halve its per marla figure from 28 to 14 lakh. Beyond the title there is nothing on possession, development status or exact position.

The useful next step is a working scrape rather than more analysis: collect the real result pages, keep the scrape date and the listing type, and then the price per marla by sector, with a sensible minimum count, becomes worth computing. With repeated scrapes over time the same table would also show how asking prices move.